

Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

November 8, 2025

Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Adyen plugs into Meal Ticket to modernize distributor payments

Adyen just teamed up with Meal Ticket to bring embedded payments to foodservice distributors — a sector that still runs on checks, phone orders, and clunky AR. The integration puts cards, ACH, and online pay-by-link inside Meal Ticket's workflow, with onboarding, reporting, and reconciliation handled end-to-end by Adyen. Why should payment folks care? Vertical SaaS partnerships like this are where B2B payments modernization is happening: faster collections, lower DSO, fewer manual headaches, and stickier software. For distributors, it means getting paid across field sales, portals, and back-office without patchwork gateways or ERPs doing gymnastics. For Adyen, it's a deeper push into U.S. B2B volumes beyond retail — capturing high-ticket, repeat payments with better data, risk tools, and unified rails. Expect improved cash flow for distributors, more digital payment adoption by restaurants, and a new monetization lever for Meal Ticket through payments revenue. The bigger story: embedded payments are now table stakes in niche B2B workflows, and platforms that streamline onboarding and reconciliation will win share as distributors finally trade paper for pixels.

Source: PaymentsDive

<https://www.paymentsdive.com/press-release/20240826-meal-ticket-partners-with-adyen-to-launch-payment-solutions-for-food-servic-1/>

Article 2

Adyen taps Plaid to push pay by bank into the mainstream

Adyen just teamed up with Plaid, and the pitch is simple: make bank based payments and account verification as easy as card checkout. Plaid brings its open banking pipes and instant account linking; Adyen layers on checkout, acquiring, risk controls and settlement. For merchants, that could mean lower acceptance costs versus cards, fewer chargebacks on account to account payments, faster onboarding and smoother payouts. For Adyen, it's a way to widen its payment mix, tap richer bank data for risk, and keep large clients inside its full stack ecosystem. And for Plaid, it's a distribution boost into enterprise merchants via a global PSP. What it means: the industry is nudging consumers toward pay by bank for subscriptions, bill pay and high ticket purchases where interchange stings. If PSPs can make bank payments one click and reliable, card volumes could face pressure at the margin. The caveats remain—habits, rewards, refund flows and bank UX are stubborn—and in some markets guarantees and speed still lag cards. But with open banking maturing and instant rails spreading, this tie up is another sign that “cards vs. accounts” is becoming a real commercial choice, not just a tech demo.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/>

Article 3

Adyen brings card issuing to the U.S. to power embedded finance

Adyen isn't content with just moving money anymore. The Dutch fintech has rolled out card issuing in the U.S., letting enterprises and platforms spin up virtual and physical cards for things like instant payouts, controlled spend, and loyalty. In plain English: a marketplace can pay gig workers faster, a retailer can run closed-loop programs, and a platform can manage expenses—all without stitching together multiple vendors. The bigger story is Adyen's end to end play. By pairing issuing with its acquiring, risk, and checkout, Adyen keeps more economics in-house and can use unified data to nudge up authorization rates and reduce fraud. That puts pressure on pure-play issuers like Marqeta and rivals like Stripe, while giving merchants a single API and global footprint to scale embedded finance ideas quickly. Of course, issuing isn't plug-and-play—there's KYC, compliance, and program risk to manage, and vendor lock in is real. But for execs chasing margin and speed, Adyen's one stop shop makes "payments" feel more like a platform strategy than a utility.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/>

Article 4

Adyen rides the BNPL holiday wave with Klarna tie-up

Buy now, pay later (BNPL) is gearing up for a holiday sprint, and Adyen wants a front row seat. The Dutch payments processor is deepening its integration with Swedish BNPL heavyweight Klarna, making "Pay Later" options easier to switch on across Adyen's merchant network just as festive baskets get bigger. For retailers, this is a conversion play: give shoppers flexible installments at checkout, lift average order values, and chip away at cart abandonment without revamping payments plumbing. For Adyen, it's more processed volume and stickier merchant relationships—without taking on consumer credit risk, since Klarna carries the financing. Klarna, in turn, gets distribution at scale by plugging into Adyen's global rails, bypassing one off integrations with enterprise merchants. The broader takeaway? Checkout is becoming a bundle—payments plus embedded financing—as processors, wallets, and card networks vie to own that moment. Regulatory scrutiny of BNPL isn't going away, but demand is clearly there. Watch adoption across categories, authorization performance, and whether BNPL economics hold up when shoppers get cost conscious and fees get scrutinized.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/>

Article 5

Square's new Handheld cuts the smartphone out of POS

Square made its name turning phones into card readers. Now it wants you to ditch the phone. The company has launched Handheld, a purpose-built, all in one POS device that runs Square's software and takes payments on its own. The pitch is simple: fewer moving parts, faster checkouts, and a standardized tool for frontline staff—especially in busy retail aisles, curbside, or at restaurant tables. What it means: Square is pushing deeper into on-the-floor commerce where reliability, durability and speed matter more than a slick BYOD setup. It also shrinks Square's dependency on Apple/Android hardware policies and puts it toe to toe with rivals like Clover Flex, Toast's handhelds, and Shopify's POS Go. For merchants, the trade off is convenience versus lock in: a tighter, more seamless setup, but one more proprietary device to buy and manage. For Square (Block), hardware is the wedge; the real money still comes from payments volume and software subscriptions that follow. If Handheld boosts throughput and standardizes the checkout experience, expect higher ARPU and stickier accounts. The risk? Hardware margins, supply chain complexity, and the need to prove it's meaningfully better than a phone plus reader.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/>

Article 6

Square adds Bitcoin checkout for small businesses—boon or burden?

Square is giving small merchants a crypto upgrade, letting them accept Bitcoin at checkout. Translation: Square wants to be the one-stop till for cards, wallets and now crypto. For stores, the headline perk is choice—tap into a younger, crypto-savvy customer base and potentially cut some card fees on cross-border sales. The catch? Bitcoin's price jumps around, and its network can be pricey and slow at busy times. Square says it will handle the messy bits—instant conversion to dollars to avoid volatility, and compliance/reporting—so shopkeepers don't need a crash course in crypto. It's also a new revenue line for Square through spreads and processing fees, while putting pressure on rivals like PayPal, Shopify and Coinbase Commerce. But this won't flip the payments world overnight. Most customers will still swipe a card, and merchants must weigh settlement costs, tax treatment and accounting complexity. Think of it as an optional lane, not the main highway. Still, it signals where the tills are headed: more payment options, less fear of new tech, and platforms competing to be the default operating system for small business money.

Source: PaymentsJournal

<https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/>

